

Econometrics STATA Lab: Introduction to Stata

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Week 1

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Directories

These are some useful commands to navigate through directories

- **pwd:** Check the current working folder.
- **ls:** List all the folders and files that we have in the current directory.
- **cd:** Change directory. Change the folder where we are working.

And to create directories

- **mkdir:** Create a new folder in the one that we are working.

Log file

- Make sure the Google Drive is your current directory **use_google**
- Create a new folder for week 1 **mkdir week1** (another way to create a folder).
- Make this your directory **cd "D:\PhotonUser\My Files\Google Drive\My Drive\AppStreamFiles\Stata\week01"** or simply **cd week01**
- Create a record of what you do in class **log using "wk1_log.log"**

Loading Data

- When you load/open a dataset on stata, in the background stata creates a copy of the dataset which you can then work on. Your work (creating a new variable) is not saved on the original dataset unless explicitly asked to do so. (Generally) Make sure you do not save over the original dataset and save the new dataset you have created as a separate file.
- Commands
 - ① **use** : will load a data (in Stata format) from your computer
 - ② **webuse** : will load a data that is in Stata format and stored online
 - ③ **bcuse** : will load dataset from the BC server
 - ④ **import** : used to convert other data types (excel) to stata (.dta) and then load them
 - ⑤ **clear** : allows stata to clear the memory (previous data set workrd on earlier sessions) in order to load the new one. Generally recommended at the beginning of the session

Exploring Data

- **webuse auto, clear**
- Commands for exploring the data
 - ① **des (describe)** : reports the number of observations, the number of variables, the way your data are sorted, the size of your data set, variable descriptions, and the type of storage of your data.
 - ② **br (browse)** : allows you to visualize the dataset
 - ③ **summ (summarize)** : the basic descriptive statistics
 - ④ **summ price** : detailed descriptive statistics of a variable
 - ⑤ **summ price if foreign==0**
 - ⑥ **summ price if foreign==0 & price>3000**
 - ⑦ **tab mpg**

Saving Data

- Lets create a new variable **gen price2 = price*2**
- How do we see whether the new variable has been added to the dataset?
- Now lets save this dataset
- Before use/save command make sure you are in the right directory using the **cd** or **pwd** command
- **cd**
- **save auto2**
- Lets create another variable **gen price3 = price*3**
- **save auto2 ?????**
- Two options : save with a new name or **save auto2, replace**
- Finally close your log file **log close**

Tell me how the course is going

- Anonymous, about 1 minute, all questions optional.
- Pick the week, your section, and rate the pace.
- Fill it in once for each week, if you like.

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